

This new chip will let you stream music directly into your brain

Elon Musk's artificial intelligence (AI) firm Neuralink is developing a brain chip that will allow people to stream music directly to their brains. Responding to a computer scientist Austin Howard on Twitter, Musk confirmed that Neuralink technology will enable users to listen to music directly from their chips.

Musk's comment comes shortly after he invited people with expertise in mobile devices and wearables to join Neuralink.

According to Musk, the technology can solve a lot of brain/spine injuries and is ultimately essential for AI symbiosis.

Neuralink had showcased the brain-on-chip last year. Aimed at users suffering from paralysis and brain disorders, the chip contains tiny threads that help perform certain tasks.

The company claims that these threads are long-lasting and could potentially replace the current generation of unwieldy brain-machine interfaces. The company had planned to conduct human trials this year.

The chip can be controlled through an application on the iPhone. Called N1 sensor, it can be paired with a USB port. The setup includes as many as 96 threads, with each thread being smaller than the human hair.

Facebook bots to combat bad behaviour

Facebook has deployed an army of bots in a simulated version of the social network to study their behaviour and track how they devolve into antisocial activity.

Drawing principles from machine learning (ML), artificial intelligence (AI), game theory, and multiagent systems, Facebook engineers developed the program—Web-Enabled Simulation (WES)—a highly realistic, large-scale replica of Facebook.



Representational image

They hope to remedy the explosive growth of online harassment, especially in this era of political misinformation, crackpot conspiracy theories, and hate speech. WES bots are trained to interact with one another, send messages, comment on posts, and make friend requests. They cannot interact with actual users.

Mark Harman, the lead Facebook research scientist who posted a summary of the WES effort on a blog, explains, "The WES approach can automatically explore complicated scenarios in a simulated environment. While the project is in a research-only stage at the moment, the hope is that one day it will help us improve our services and spot potential reliability or integrity issues before they affect real people using the platform."

Millions of bots with different objectives are deployed in the experimental system. Some, for instance, attempt to purchase items that are not permitted on the site, such as guns or drugs. Researchers track patterns applied by the bots as they conduct searches, visit pages, and replicate actions that humans might take. And then assess various counter-measures to stop or even prevent undesirable behaviours.

This LED face mask lets you customise your messages

Face masks are compulsory now and have crossed over from looking boring and unimpressive to the designer domain. Recently, fashion entrepreneur Chelsea Klukas of Lumen Couture launched cool LED face masks.

Speaking to The Verge, Klukas said that she had components lying around, so she put together a quick DIY YouTube tutorial on how to make these masks. The video went viral, and there were people asking Klukas to make ready-to-wear masks.

These LED face masks come with dual-layer cotton and mesh, along with a chargeable LED flex panel. The panel can be removed for sanitisation and cleaning. The mask comes with a battery and a charging cord.

The LED Display on the mask is a thin LED matrix screen that users can customise through an app. You can add drawings, text, and even voice inputs. The fabric used to make the mask is breathable above and below the screen.

The app that controls the panel has a microphone input, and wearers can use it to display social distancing messages like stand back or 6 feet.



Fashion entrepreneur Chelsea Klukas of Lumen Couture has launched cool LED face masks. (Credit: Chelsea Klukas/Lumen Couture)